5.7 WRITING LESSONS 9–10

OVERVIEW

Duration: 40+40 minutes

Objectives:
- Can understand basic types of standard letters and emails on familiar topics (e.g. enquiries, complaints) (Ca) (GSE 46 – B1).
- Can write a formal email/letter requesting information (P) (GSE 54 – B1+).

Resources:
- SB pp. 68–69
- TB: Culture notes p. 174; Photocopiable Resource 28 pp. 206, 243
- WB pp. 68–69
- Online resources: Teacher's Resources, Sample answer for Exercise 8

LESSON 9

WARM-UP | 6–8 minutes

1 (T–S, S–T) Books closed. Activate Ss' interest in the topic. Ask: *Which factors do you consider while choosing a school to do a course?* Elicit answers and have a brief class discussion. Then hold a class vote for the most important factor.

2 (T–S, S–T) Ask Ss to turn to p. 68 and look at Exercise 1. Give them 2 minutes to read the ad and write down three questions they would like to ask about the school. Then elicit the questions.

TIP

See Culture notes in TB p. 174 for information about IELTS, TOEFL, PTE and Cambridge English Qualifications.

PRACTICE | 30–32 minutes

1 (T–S, S–T) Refer Ss to Exercise 2. Give them 2 minutes to read Analisa's email and see if she asked any of the questions they wrote down and what other questions she asked. Elicit answers and check.

2 (T–S, S–T) Ss do Exercise 3 individually. Give them 1 minute to put the sentences in order, then check.

3 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Refer Ss to Exercise 4. Tell them to read the WRITING FOCUS and complete the examples with the phrases in purple in the email in Exercise 2. Give Ss 2 minutes and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check. Go through the WRITING FOCUS with the class and check Ss understand the phrases which can be used while writing an email / a letter of enquiry. Wherever possible, suggest alternative words and phrases to replace the ones given there. Drill the words and phrases as a whole class and with random individuals if necessary.

4 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Refer Ss to Exercise 5. Give them 2 minutes to read and complete the LANGUAGE FOCUS with examples in the email in Exercise 2 and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs. When they are ready, elicit the answers and check. Then go through the LANGUAGE FOCUS with the class. Make sure Ss understand when to use indirect questions and how to form them. Be prepared to offer further examples if necessary or ask Ss to come up with their own examples.

5 (S–S, T–S, S–T) Ss do Exercise 6 individually. Give them 3 minutes to complete the indirect questions and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check.

6 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Ss do Exercise 7 individually. Give them 3 minutes to rewrite the email so that it is more formal and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs. As they do this, walk around monitoring, supporting and taking notes of any problems. Then do a class check and give some feedback.

LESSON 10

PRODUCTION | 38 minutes

1 (T–S, S–T) Exercise 8. Refer Ss to the writing task. Give them 1 minute to read quickly through the rubric and the advertisement and underline the key words. Elicit them from Ss. Then read through the information Ss should include and check understanding. Give Ss 15 minutes to write an email to the school including all required information. Remind Ss to use the WRITING FOCUS and the LANGUAGE FOCUS to help them. Also, tell them that they can use Analisa's email as a model for their writing. As they do this, walk around monitoring and supporting if necessary.

2 (S–S) When Ss have finished writing, tell them to self-check their emails.

TIP

To help Ss with this, prepare a checklist beforehand and give a copy of it to each S in the class. You can write questions similar to the following on the list: *Have you used indirect questions? Have you started and closed the email with the correct phrases? Have you mentioned all the points in the question? Have you checked your spelling and punctuation?* Explain to Ss that they need to tick each item on the checklist to show that they have checked their piece of writing for that item. Monitor and support as they do this.

3 (S–S) Then put Ss in pairs and tell them to swap their emails. Ss should now check if their partner's email includes all the information and if everything is clear and then they give it back.

TIP

Ss can edit each other's work again using the checklist you gave to them.

4 (S–S) Give Ss another 5 minutes to make changes to their emails based on the feedback they got from their partner before handing them in for your evaluation and feedback. Finally, do a class feedback session.

5 (T–S, S–T) Give Ss a model text for Exercise 8 and ask them to compare it with their own. Alternatively, this could be omitted or could be done in a following lesson if you are short of time.

HOMEWORK

1 Give Ss WB pp. 68–69 as homework.

2 Ask Ss to make a list of phrases they know for giving opinions, agreeing and disagreeing, e.g. *I think, In my opinion, I agree, I don't agree.* Begin the class by pooling their ideas and writing them on the board.

CONTINGENCY PLAN

Refer to TB p. 68 for extra activities.